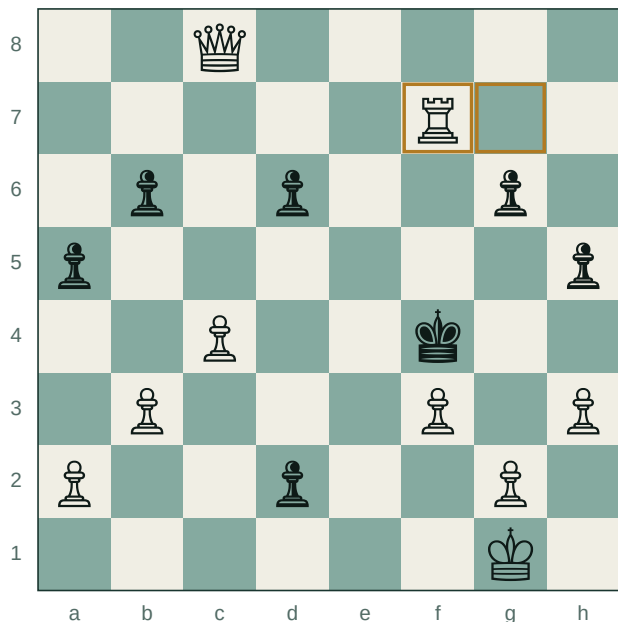


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 45

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 45.Rf7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45...Kg3 46. Qg4+ hxg4 47. fxg4 d1=Q+

45...Kg3 The king moves from f4 to g3. Recorded reply: **46.Qg4+**.

46...hxg4 The pawn captures the queen on g4. Recorded reply: **47.fxg4**.

47...d1=Q+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +16. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +16: the balance goes from -14 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c8 and rook on f7. Check for tactical protection.